DIGITAL LOST AND FOUND SYSTEM

Semester Project Report by

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Abstract

This project implements a web-based Digital Lost and Found System designed to streamline the reporting and recovery of misplaced items. The application provides an intuitive user interface where individuals can submit lost or found item reports by uploading images, descriptions, locations, and dates. The system incorporates form handling, data validation, and structured item submission to ensure accuracy and consistency. An admin panel serves as the verification layer, where submitted posts are reviewed, approved, or rejected to maintain authenticity and prevent misuse. Users can browse and search items using smart filters such as category, location, and date, allowing efficient item discovery and matching. The platform's workflow includes item posting, admin moderation, and user communication, creating a reliable process for item recovery. While the system operates primarily as a client–server web application without advanced automation or AI-based matching, it effectively demonstrates core concepts such as user interaction, data management, filtering logic, secure moderation, and digital record-keeping. This project highlights foundational principles of web application development, including form validation, modular design, structured data flow, and user-centered functionality, making it a suitable example of how digital solutions can improve everyday organizational processes.

Introduction

The Lost and Found Web System is a comprehensive online platform designed to simplify the process of reporting, managing, and recovering lost items. Traditional methods of handling lost and found items often involve manual record-keeping, physical notice boards, or word-of-mouth communication, which can be inefficient, time-consuming, and prone to errors. This project provides a centralized, user-friendly web application where users can easily register lost or found items, upload item details and images, and communicate securely with other users to facilitate recovery.

The system incorporates features such as search and filter options to quickly locate specific items, notifications for matching lost and found reports, and an organized database to track the status of each item. By digitizing the lost and found process, this project not only improves efficiency but also enhances transparency, accountability, and user convenience. It demonstrates the practical application of modern web technologies to solve a common real-world problem, bridging the gap between technology and everyday needs.

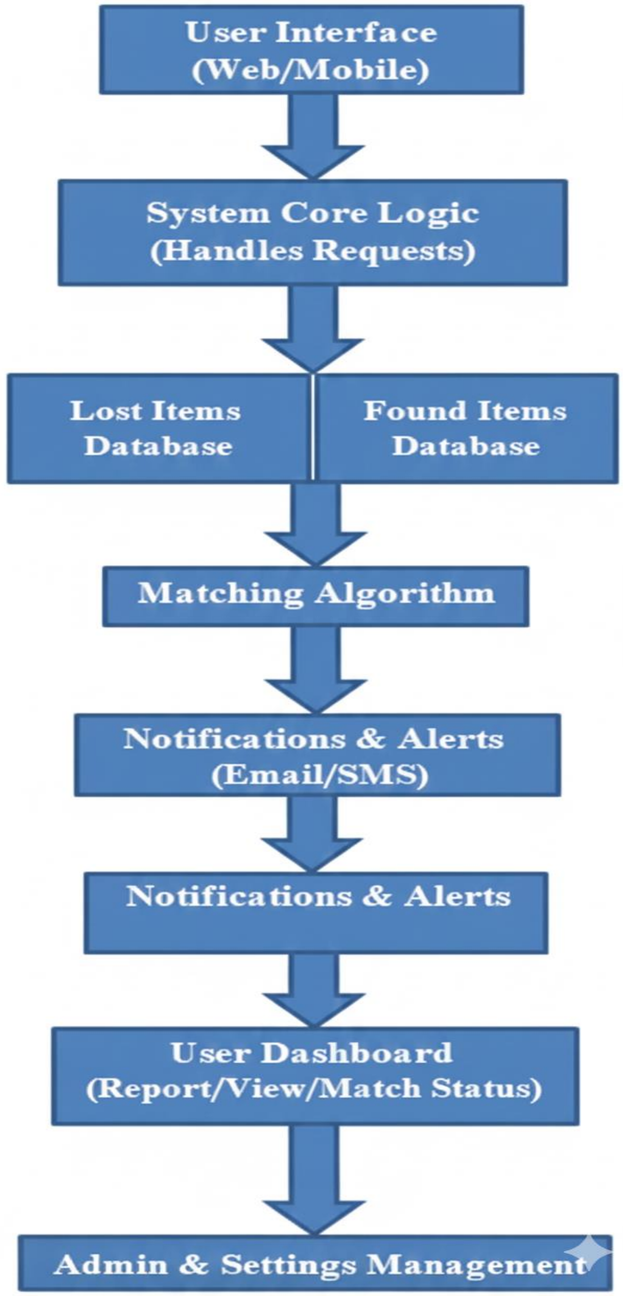


Figure 1:Block Diagram of Lost and Found System

Problem Statement

People often misplace important belongings in public places such as schools, malls, parks, and transportation areas. Existing lost-and-found processes are manual, slow, and poorly organized due to the absence of a central digital system. Because of this inefficiency, many valuable items remain unclaimed. Therefore, a centralized digital platform is required to streamline reporting, searching, and recovering lost and found items.

Project aims and goals

- Create an online platform to report lost or found items.
- Allow uploading of images, descriptions, date, and location.
- Provide smart search filters for easy item discovery.
- Enable communication between item finder and owner.
- Ensure security and trust through admin moderation.
- Increase recovery success rate through automation.

Project Methodology

The methodology for developing the Lost and Found System involves a structured approach that covers all stages of software development, ensuring the system is user-friendly, efficient, and secure. The methodology is divided into the following phases:

1. Requirement Analysis:

- Gather requirements from potential users, including students, staff, and visitors.
- Identify key functionalities such as reporting lost items, listing found items, searching items, and contacting the owner/finder.
- Define system constraints, usability requirements, and performance expectations.

2. System Design:

- Create the architectural design of the system including database schema, frontend, and backend structure.
- Design user interface (UI) wireframes for forms, dashboards, and search functionality to ensure a smooth user experience.

3. Technology Selection:

- **Frontend:** HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and Bootstrap for responsive design.
- **Backend:** Node.js/Express or PHP for server-side processing.
- **Database:** MySQL or MongoDB to store user data and lost/found item records.
- **Additional Tools:** React for dynamic components, and email notifications for alerts.

4. Implementation:

Develop the frontend interface with input forms for lost and found items, search functionality, and user dashboards.

- Implement backend logic for adding, updating, and retrieving items from the database.
- Integrate search algorithms to allow users to find items efficiently using keywords, categories, and date filters.
- Implement user authentication for secure access and management.

5. Testing:

- Conduct unit testing for individual modules such as form validation, search functionality, and notifications.
- Perform integration testing to ensure all system components work together seamlessly.
- Carry out user acceptance testing (UAT) with a small group to gather feedback on usability and performance.

6. Deployment:

- Deploy the system on a web server or cloud platform for public access.
- Ensure proper security measures such as SSL certificates and data encryption are implemented.

7. **Maintenance and Updates:**

- Monitor system performance and user feedback for potential improvements.
- Update features as required, such as enhancing search filters, adding notifications, or improving database efficiency.

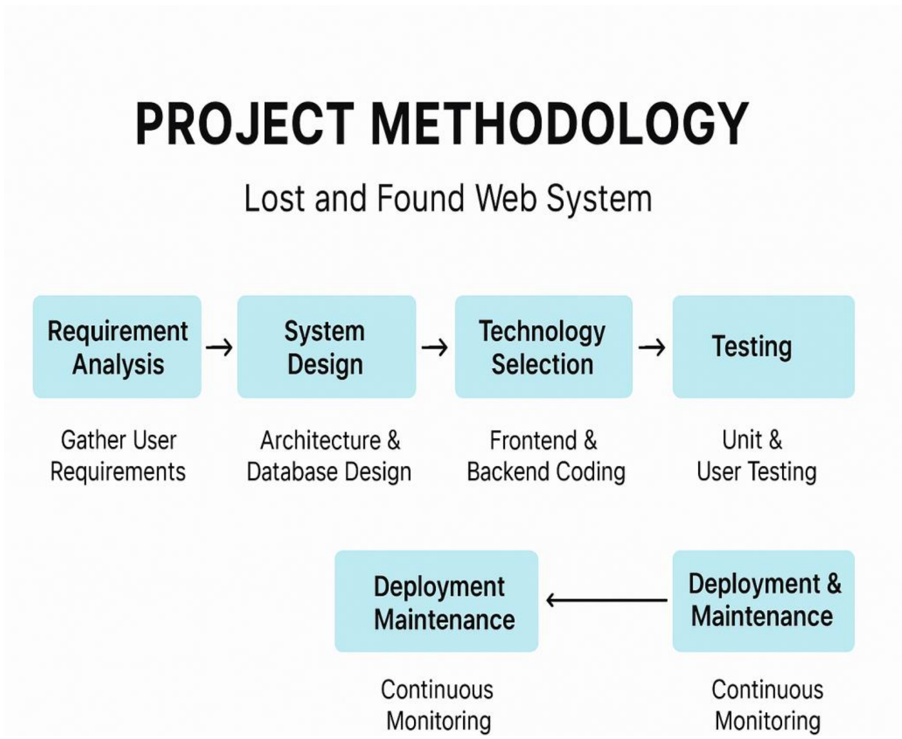


Figure 2: Project Methodology

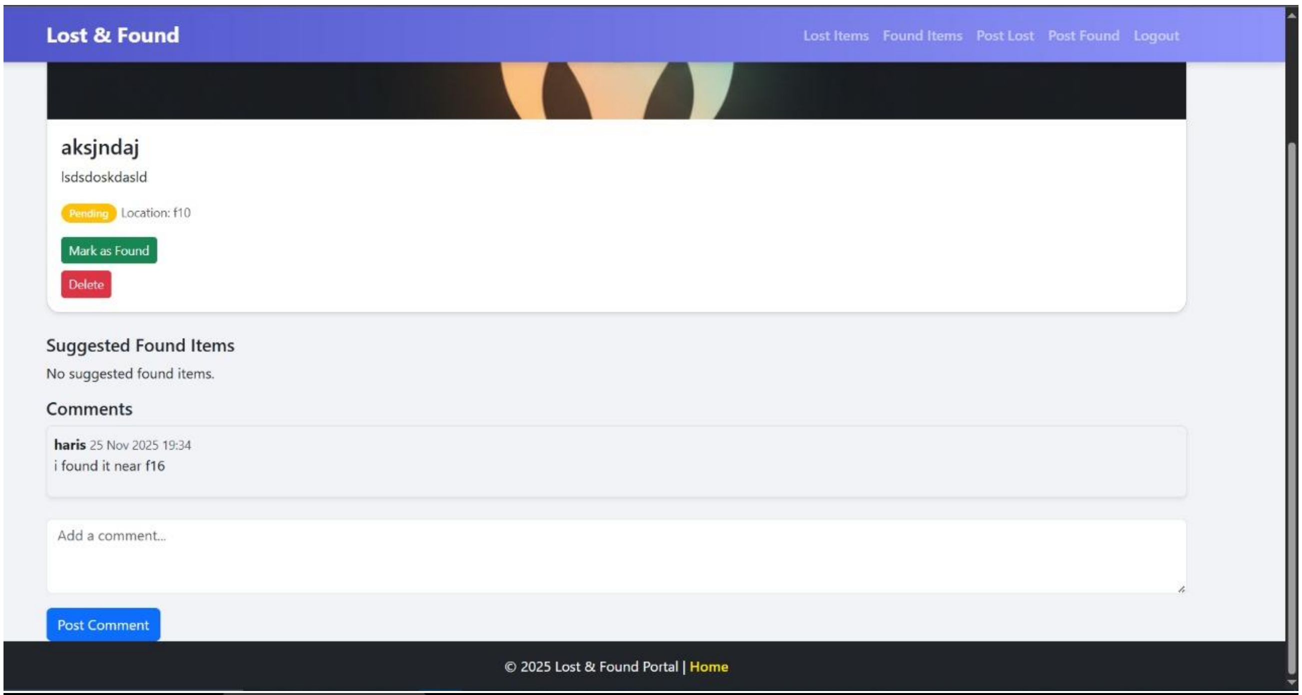
Conclusion

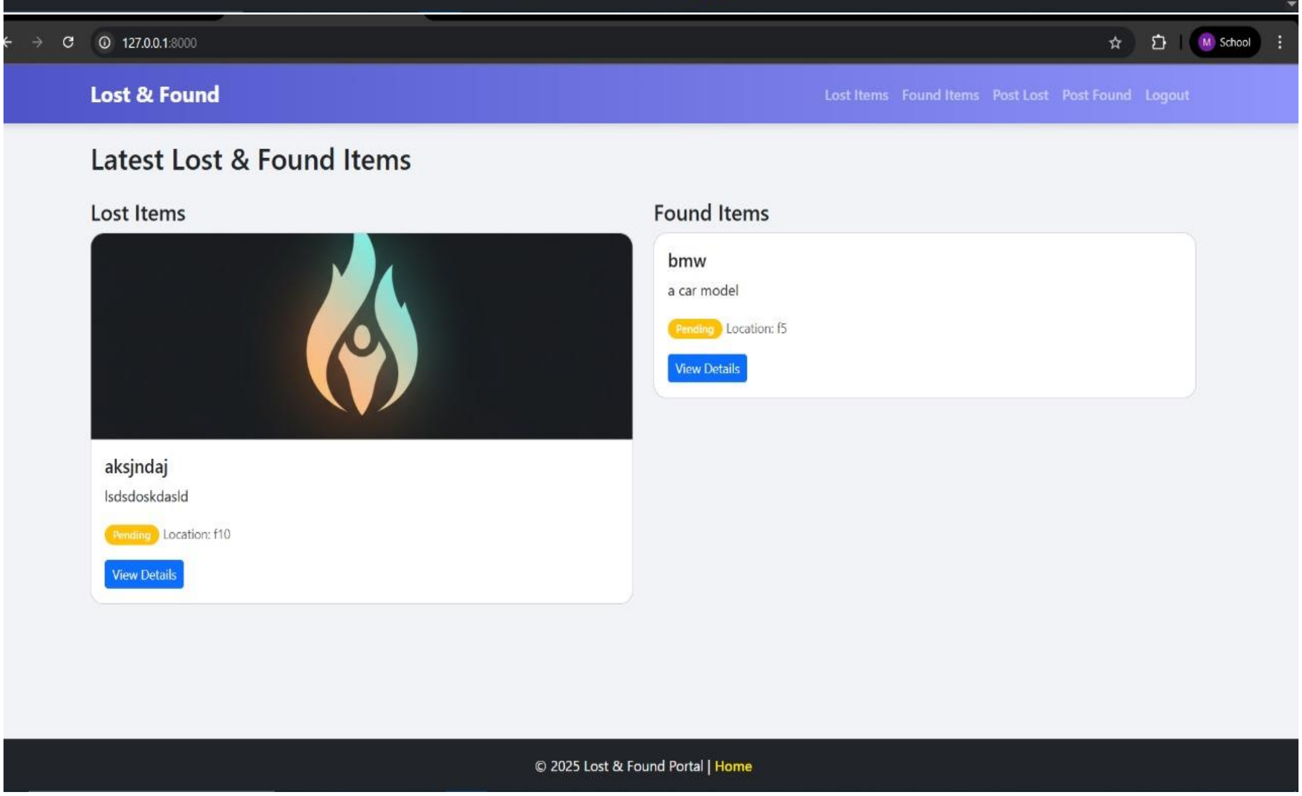
The Lost and Found System project successfully provides a practical and efficient solution for managing lost and found items in an organization or community. By leveraging web technologies such as HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Bootstrap, and React, along with a robust backend and database, the system ensures that users can report, search, and retrieve lost items quickly and conveniently.

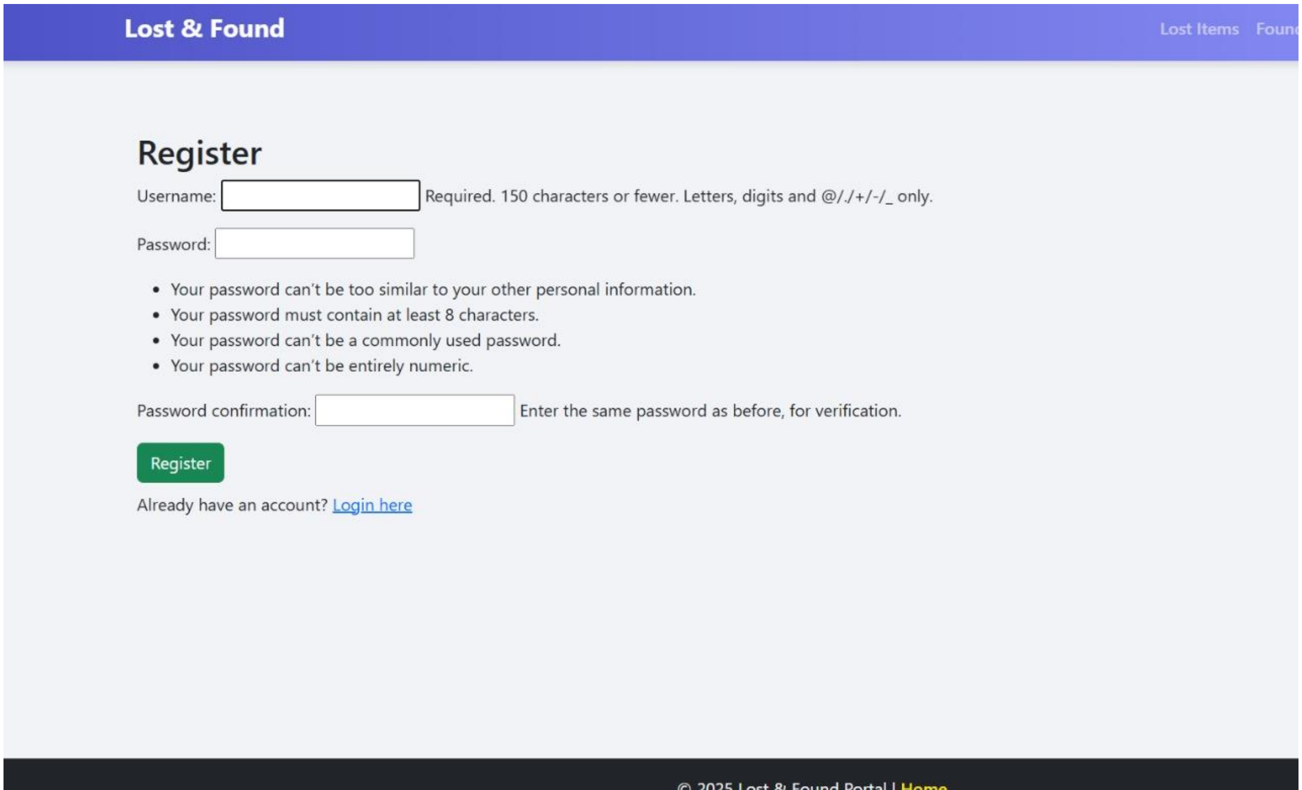
This project enhances the overall user experience by offering a structured and organized platform, reducing the frustration and time associated with locating lost items. The implementation of features like real-time search, user authentication, and notifications improves both security and usability.

Moreover, the system demonstrates the importance of integrating modern web technologies to solve real-world problems, promoting better communication and collaboration between users. In conclusion, the Lost and Found System is a reliable, user-friendly, and scalable solution that effectively addresses the challenges of managing lost items, ultimately improving efficiency and satisfaction for its users.

Final Pictures of Project






Lost & Found
Lost Items
Register
Username:
Required. 150 characters or fewer. Letters, digits and @/./+/-/_ only.
Password:
Your password can't be too similar to your other personal information.
Your password must contain at least 8 characters.
Your password can't be a commonly used password.
Your password can't be entirely numeric.
Password confirmation:
Enter the same password as before, for verification.
Register
Already have an account? Login here
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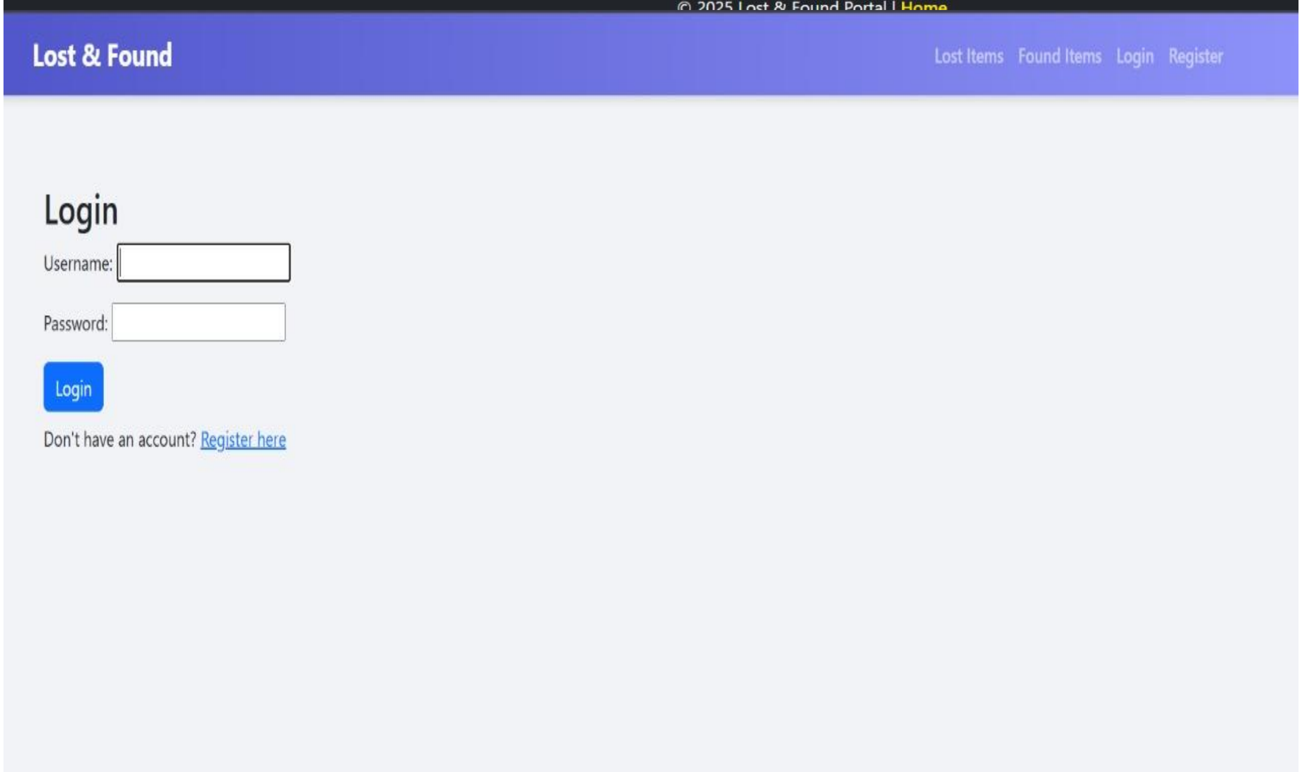
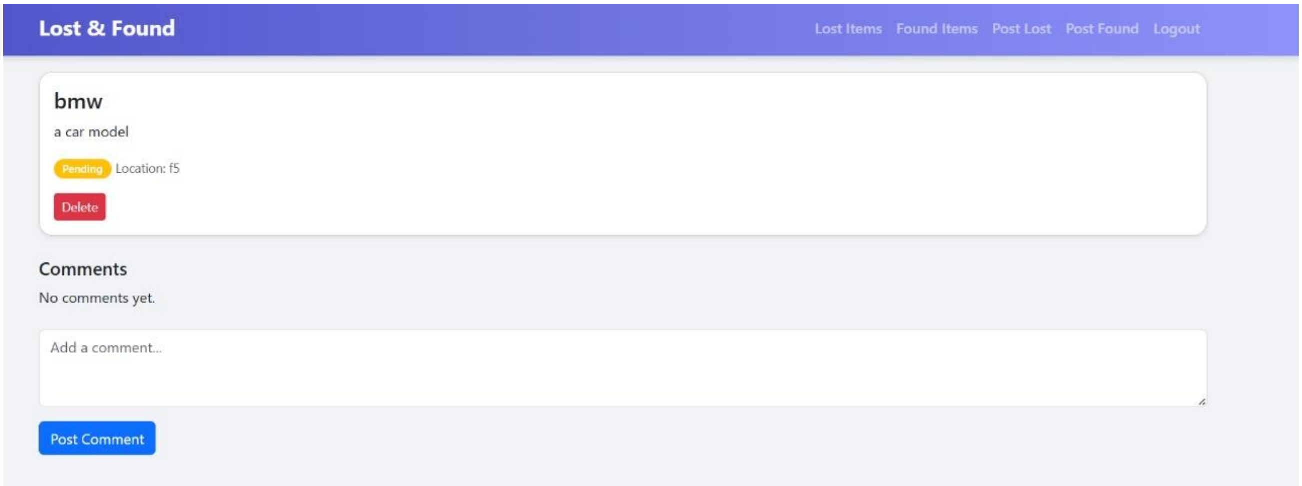
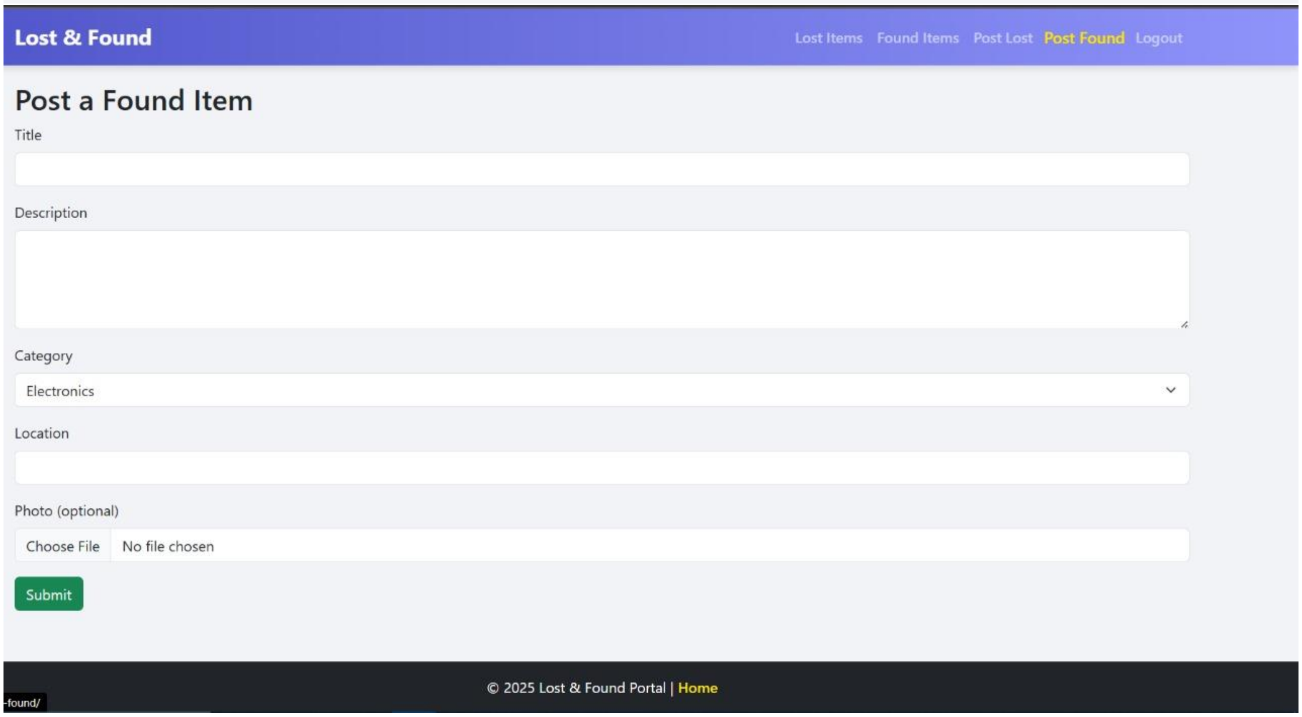

Lost & Found
Lost Items
Found Items
Login
Register
Login
Username:
Password:
Login
Don't have an account? Register here


Lost & Found
Lost Items Found Items Post Lost Post Found Logout
bmw
a car model
Pending Location: f5
Delete
Comments
No comments yet.
Add a comment...
Post Comment


Lost & Found
Lost Items Found Items Post Lost Post Found Logout
Post a Found Item
Title
Description
Category
Electronics
Location
Photo (optional)
Choose File No file chosen
Submit
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